Carl Drechsel

Cloud & AI Transformation Leader | Enterprise Digital Workplace Strategy | Microsoft Ecosystem Architect

Western New York | Linkedin

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Enterprise AI Transformation and Digital Workplace leader with 20+ years driving large-scale cloud, collaboration, and identity initiatives with a strong focus on AI adoption and business value realization. Proven ability to translate Microsoft AI capabilities—including Microsoft 365 Copilot—into real-world enterprise outcomes by aligning technology, workflows, and organizational change.

- AI Workforce Transformation: Driving end-to-end Copilot and AI adoption across Microsoft 365, Teams, and enterprise workflows
- Business Value Realization: Aligns AI and technology investments to measurable outcomes, including a $5M enterprise licensing optimization
- Strategic Focus: Embedding AI into knowledge work through workflow redesign, adoption strategy, and change management

STRATEGY & AI WORKFORCE EXPERTISE

AI adoption, Copilot enablement, and business value realization • AI use case development • Technology strategy and delivery alignment • Executive advisory & stakeholder engagement • Change management & adoption strategy • Team leadership and cross-functional alignment

Microsoft 365 & Copilot platforms • Identity architecture & Zero Trust • Cloud architecture (Azure + M365) • Enterprise collaboration • Compliance & governance

ENTERPRISE AI ENABLEMENT

Lead enterprise AI enablement initiatives across Microsoft 365 and Azure, focusing on Copilot adoption, workflow transformation, and measurable business outcomes.

- Designed AI readiness strategies aligned to enterprise architecture, identity, governance, and Microsoft 365 platforms including Copilot
- Identified knowledge work inefficiencies and defined AI-enabled use cases to improve productivity and decision-making
- Developed frameworks for embedding AI into collaboration ecosystems (Teams, SharePoint, Microsoft 365) within existing enterprise workflows
- Advise enterprise leaders on AI adoption, governance, and value realization, aligning initiatives to measurable business outcomes

AI PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT | SalesInsight — AI Sales Intelligence Platform (Founder / Architect)

Led the design and development of an applied AI platform that transforms unstructured sales conversations into structured intelligence used for deal strategy, opportunity analysis, and proposal development.

- Designed structured Sales Intelligence Briefs that convert conversation data into strategic deal and execution insights
- Built a workflow architecture combining LLM-based analysis, structured output models, and automation to accelerate proposal generation and opportunity alignment
- Demonstrates applied use of AI to enhance enterprise knowledge workflows, decision clarity, and execution outcomes

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Global Technology Consulting Organization | Senior Solutions Architect - Enterprise AI Enablement & Digital Workplace | *July 2022 – Present*

Lead enterprise AI and Cloud transformation engagements across Azure and Microsoft 365 environments, driving delivery across complex, multi-stakeholder initiatives.

- Drive execution across AI and Copilot engagements by aligning stakeholders, removing delivery blockers, and ensuring successful adoption outcomes
- Lead Copilot and AI Workforce engagements, guiding customers from readiness through adoption, use case development, and measurable value realization across Microsoft 365 environments
- Guide solution design across Microsoft 365 and Azure environments, ensuring alignment to enterprise architecture, identity, governance, and AI enablement strategies
- Mentor and support technical professionals through coaching, interview participation, and strategic resource evaluation
- Navigate complex enterprise environments and stakeholder dynamics to resolve delivery challenges and maintain engagement momentum
- Engage business and technical stakeholders to define AI use cases, align solutions to business outcomes, and drive adoption of Microsoft AI capabilities
- Translate Microsoft AI capabilities into business value by aligning solutions to productivity gains, decision-making improvements, and operational efficiency

Key Strategic Engagements:

Global Investment Firm – Enterprise EUX Transformation Strategy

- Introduced AI and Copilot-aligned use case discussions to support future workforce productivity transformation
- Led enterprise EUX transformation strategy spanning device lifecycle modernization, identity alignment, and collaboration governance
- Identified workflow friction impacting workforce productivity and guided discussions on future productivity enablement including emerging AI capabilities

Regional Healthcare System – Microsoft 365 Tenant Consolidation

- Consolidated multiple Microsoft 365 tenants into a unified collaboration platform reducing operational complexity
- Improved cross-organization collaboration through unified identity services

Global Insurance Provider – Security & Risk Governance

- Architected Insider Risk Management and Communications Compliance capabilities supporting regulatory obligations
- Strengthened governance visibility through Microsoft 365 E5 security controls

Large U.S. Financial Institution – Teams Compliance Architecture

- Designed and piloted Teams compliance architecture supporting retention, supervision, and policy enforcement
- Enabled regulatory recordkeeping and supervisory control workflows

National Healthcare Organization – Security & Compliance Assessment

- Assessed identity and data protection risks within Microsoft 365 environment
- Delivered prioritized remediation roadmap strengthening security controls

World Wide Technology | **Senior Solutions Architect - Microsoft Security & Modern Workplace |** *August 2021 – July 2022*

Recruited to lead the development of Microsoft security consulting capabilities within the consulting services organization, establishing service offerings, shaping go-to-market strategy, and supporting early-stage customer engagements.

- Led the build-out of Microsoft security consulting services, defining offerings aligned to Microsoft 365 security, compliance, and identity solutions
- Partnered with sales and leadership to shape engagements and drive early adoption, translating customer requirements into scoped solutions and delivery approaches
- Contributed to go-to-market strategy and positioned Microsoft security capabilities within enterprise accounts to drive consulting opportunities
- Transitioned into modern work and AI-focused engagements following organizational realignment, applying prior experience to broader digital workplace and transformation initiatives

M&T Bank | **Enterprise Architect III, AVP — Enterprise Infrastructure (End User Services)** | *September 2019 – August 2021*

Domain architect responsible for modern workplace strategy across collaboration platforms, identity architecture, and workforce productivity services.

Defined enterprise technology direction supporting secure, scalable digital workplace services for a large financial services environment.

- Led early Azure adoption strategy, establishing foundational cloud direction aligned to identity, security, and enterprise workloads
- **Cost Optimization:** Directed Microsoft licensing strategy generating **$5M in savings** through persona-based optimization.
- **Modernization:** Developed Zero Trust identity blueprint and virtual desktop strategy for cloud-delivered workspaces.
- **Governance:** Led architecture governance for enterprise migration to Microsoft 365.

M&T Bank | **Technical Engineer IV, Bank Officer |***December 2015 – September 2019*

Led technical architecture and delivery for enterprise collaboration modernization initiatives.

- Led enterprise Office 365 deployment enabling secure modern collaboration.
- Designed Azure AD Connect & Conditional Access supporting identity-as-a-service.
- Implemented MFA and governance controls supporting 20,000+ users.

AtoS (Industrial Sector Client) | **Senior Messaging Engineer** | *October 2012 – December 2015*

- Migrated 120,000 mailboxes across global environment.

GSX Solutions | **Senior Technical Product Manager |** *January 2011 – October 2012*

- Defined product strategy and architecture for Microsoft Exchange and SharePoint monitoring solutions - Speaker at Microsoft Tech-Ed North America 2012

Sodexo | **Senior Global Messaging & Collaboration Engineer** | *September 2006 – December 2010*

- Consolidated 82 global email systems into a unified architecture for 100,000 users.

CERTIFICATIONS - Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) • Microsoft 365 Certified: Security Administrator Associate *(expired)*

EDUCATION - MBA, SUNY Buffalo • BS, Management & Marketing, Canisius College • AAS, Business Administration, Erie Community College